📚 SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 27

Classic Email Templates in Salesforce

Complete Guide with Practical Demo — Merge Fields, Custom HTML & Dynamic Communication

- 📧 What are Classic Email Templates?
- 🧩 4 Classic Template Types
- 🔤 Salesforce Merge Language (SML)
- 🔗 Related Object Merge Fields
- 🛠️ Create Custom HTML Template Hands-on
- ⚖️ Classic (SML) vs. Lightning (HML)

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL
27 of Series	~25.5 Minutes	Intermediate

CORE AUTOMATION

Customer Communication

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SECTION 1

🎬 Introduction & Course Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:50

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In previous episodes, we learned about automation workflows such as *Approval Processes*, *Web-to-Lead*, and *Case Routing*.

Now think about everyday operational communication: Support agents solve dozens of cases daily, and sales reps follow up on hundreds of leads. If each employee manually types: *"Hello John, thank you for reaching out. Your Case #1024 has been resolved..."* every single time, companies suffer from massive wasted hours, typos, and inconsistent branding.

Salesforce solves this with **Email Templates** — build an email once, standardize company branding, and dynamically personalize content using **Merge Fields**!

SECTION 2

📧 What are Classic Email Templates & Why Do We Need Them?

⏱ 0:50 – 3:30

> 📌 OFFICIAL DEFINITION
>
> **A Classic Email Template is a reusable, pre-formatted email layout in Salesforce that enables users to send standardized, professional, and dynamically personalized messages by leveraging record-specific Merge Fields.**

🎯 Core Business Advantages

- **10x Agent Productivity:** Cuts drafting time from 5 minutes per email down to 5 seconds with a single click.
- **Standardized Corporate Voice:** Ensures every customer receives legally approved, grammatically sound brand communications.
- **Zero Typo Errors:** Eliminates human mistakes in critical identifiers like Case Numbers, Account Names, and Account Executive contacts.
- **Dynamic Personalization:** Emails automatically pull live CRM data so customers receive tailored, high-touch messages.

SECTION 3

The 4 Types of Classic Email Templates

⏱ 3:30 – 6:45

TYPE 1

1. Text Email Template

Simplest format. Pure plain-text with no HTML styling, fonts, or images. Ideal for internal notifications or recipients unable to render HTML email.

TYPE 2

2. HTML with Letterhead

Uses a pre-configured **Classic Letterhead** (company logo, banner, color scheme, footer). Admins can insert text blocks inside standard corporate margins.

TYPE 3 — FOCUS DEMO

3. Custom HTML (No Letterhead)

Provides complete design freedom. Admins or developers write or paste raw HTML/CSS code directly, creating custom buttons, tables, cards, and layouts.

TYPE 4 — DEVELOPER

4. Visualforce Email Template

Developer-centric. Harnesses Visualforce markup to pull complex related-list tables (e.g., all line items in an Opportunity) or generate dynamic PDF attachments.

SECTION 4 — CORE CONCEPT

Understanding Merge Fields (Salesforce Merge Language - SML)

⏱ 6:45 – 9:30

🔑 WHAT IS A MERGE FIELD?

A merge field is a **placeholder tag**. When drafting your template, instead of writing *"Hello John"*, you insert `{!Contact.FirstName}`. When sending to John Smith, Salesforce replaces the tag with *"John"*; when sending to Sarah Miller, it replaces it with *"Sarah"*!

Classic SML Syntax Examples:

```
Subject: Welcome to {!Account.Name} Hello {!Contact.FirstName}, Thank you for being a valued customer of {!Account.Name}. Your registered phone number is {!Contact.Phone}. Your dedicated Account Executive is {!User.FirstName} {!User.LastName}.
```

💡 BEST PRACTICE: USE THE MERGE FIELD PICKER

Never try to type merge tags from memory! Always use the built-in **Available Merge Fields Picker** in Salesforce to guarantee exact object, relationship, and field API syntax.

SECTION 5 — STEP-BY-STEP HANDS-ON

Creating a Custom HTML Email Template

⏱ 9:30 – 16:00

1. In ⚙ **Setup**, search for `Classic Email Templates` and select it.
2. Click **New Template**.
3. Select **Custom (without using Classic Letterhead)** and click **Next**.
4. **Folder:** Choose *Public Email Templates* (or a department folder).
5. Check the box: **Available For Use** (mandatory so users can see it).
6. **Template Name:** `Contact Welcome Email`.
7. **Subject:** `Welcome to {!Account.Name}`.
8. **HTML Body:** Paste or write your styled HTML code (see snippet below).
9. Click **Next** → generate a plain-text fallback version for older devices → Click **Save**.

HTML Code Used in Demo:

```
<h2>Welcome {!Contact.FirstName}!</h2> <p> Thank you for becoming a customer of <strong>{!Account.Name}</strong>. We are excited to partner with you. </p> <p> If you have any questions, feel free to reach out to me directly at {!User.Email}. </p> <p> Regards,<br>{!User.FirstName} {!User.LastName} </p>
```

💉 SEND TEST AND VERIFY MERGE FIELDS

Before deploying to users, click **Send Test and Verify Merge Fields**. Select sample Contact *John Smith* and Account *ABC Technologies*, enter your personal email, and verify that all tags resolve with real values!

SECTIONS 6 & 7 — END-USER FLOW

Using Templates from Records & Attachments

⏱ 16:00 – 20:15

How End Users Use the Template:

1. Navigate to any active **Contact** record (e.g., *John Smith*).
2. In the right-hand Activity panel, click the **Email** tab to open the composer.
3. Click the **Insert, create, or update template** icon (document icon).
4. Select `Contact Welcome Email`.
5. Notice how `{!Contact.FirstName}` instantly resolves to **"John"** and `{!Account.Name}` resolves to **"ABC Technologies"**!
6. Click **Send**.

> **STATIC FILE ATTACHMENTS**
>
> You can attach static documents (e.g., `Customer_Onboarding_Guide.pdf`) directly to the template definition in Setup. Whenever an agent loads the template, the PDF automatically attaches to the outgoing email!

SECTIONS 8 & 9 — CRITICAL DISTINCTIONS

⚖️ Classic Templates (SML) vs. Lightning Templates (HML)

⏱ 20:15 – 24:00

Criterion	📜 Classic Email Templates (SML)	⚡ Lightning Email Templates (HML)
Merge Language	**Salesforce Merge Language (SML)**	**Handlebars Merge Language (HML)**
Syntax Format	`{!Contact.FirstName}`	`{{{Recipient.FirstName}}}`
Management Location	Setup → Classic Email Templates	App Launcher → Email Templates tab
Letterhead Mechanism	Classic Letterheads (Setup)	Enhanced Letterheads (Lightning Experience)
Conditional Logic	Basic; relies on formulas/Apex	Supports conditional `{{#if}}` tags

⚠️ Important Considerations & Gotchas

- **Missing Data Renders Blank:** If you use `{!Contact.Phone}` but the contact record has no phone filled in, Salesforce prints an empty blank space.
- **Available for Use Checkbox:** If this box is unchecked during creation, the template remains invisible to end users in the email composer.
- **Folder Security:** Organize templates into department folders (*Sales*, *Support*, *HR*) and grant Read/Write access strictly to relevant Public Groups.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 27

01

Classic Email Templates eliminate repetitive typing, enforce brand standards, and dynamically personalize communications.

02

4 Core Types: **Text** (plain), **HTML with Letterhead** (branded), **Custom HTML** (code control), and **Visualforce** (developer-level).

03

Classic templates utilize **Salesforce Merge Language (SML)** with the `{!Object.Field}` bracket syntax.

04

Can access parent records across lookup relationships (e.g., pulling `{!Account.Name}` from a Contact context).

05

Always test via **Send Test and Verify Merge Fields** before publishing templates to end users.

06

Remember the golden rule: **Create Once ➔ Reuse Many Times ➔ Personalize Automatically**!

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 28

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building practical, job-ready Salesforce administration and automation skills!